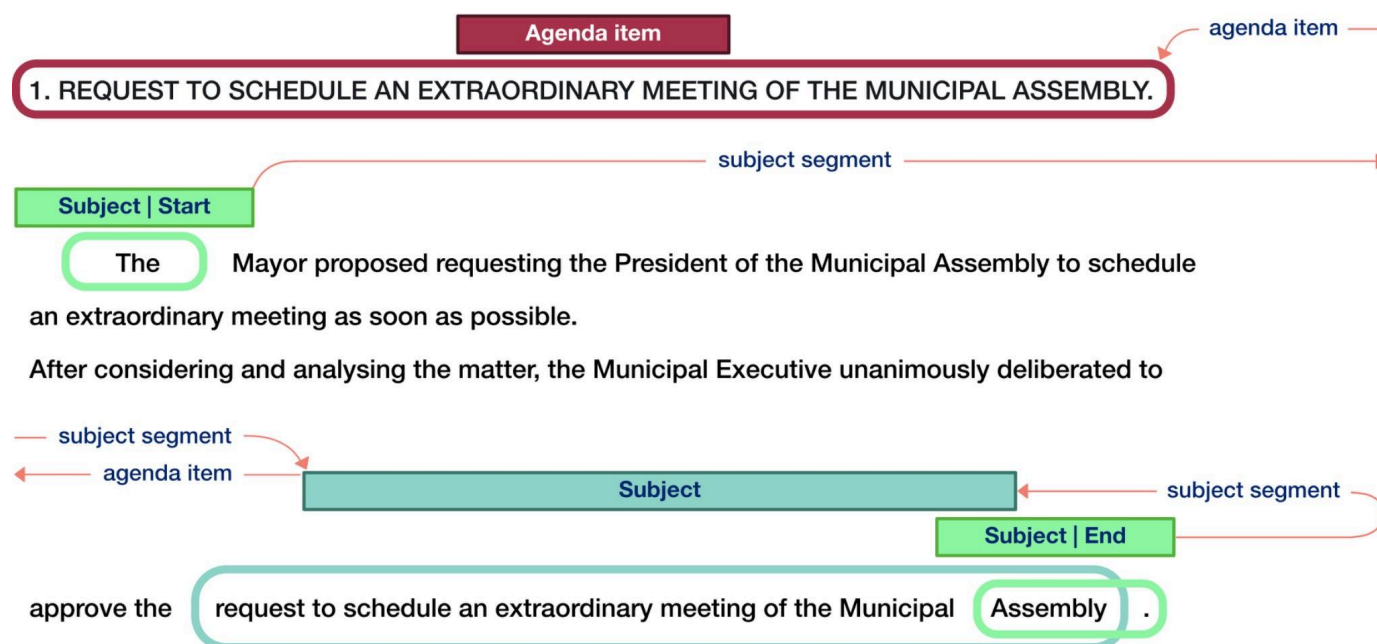


**Figure 1.** Illustrative example of subject layer link structures<sup>1</sup>.



## D. Voting

### I. Entity structures

#### • D.1. Voting evidence

**Definition:** linguistic expression indicating that a formal decision was made by means of a vote, including majority, unanimous, or other forms of deliberation that mark the outcome of the decision made by the institutional entity exercising the right to vote. The annotation of the vote allows for the textual identification of the moment in which the formal decision of the municipal executive is expressed, regardless of whether the voters are linguistically represented in the text (cf. (35) and (36)).

**Markable:** main verb, nominal or participial expression indicating that a vote took place.

<sup>1</sup> Portuguese source: "1. PEDIDO DE MARCAÇÃO DE REUNIÃO EXTRAORDINÁRIA DA ASSEMBLEIA MUNICIPAL. Pelo Senhor Presidente foi proposto solicitar ao Sr. Presidente da Assembleia Municipal a marcação de uma reunião extraordinária assim que possível. Ponderado e analisado o assunto o Executivo Municipal deliberou por unanimidade aprovar o pedido de marcação de reunião extraordinária da Assembleia Municipal."

**Examples** (markable underlined):

(34) Considered and analyzed the subject, the Municipal Executive unanimously deliberated to approve the architectural project relating to construction process no. 20/21 - EDIFIC.

(PT: *Ponderado e analisado o assunto o Executivo Municipal deliberou por unanimidade aprovar o projeto de arquitetura relativo ao processo de obras n.º 20/21 - EDIFIC.*)

(35) Deliberated to approve/ratify by majority.

(PT: *Deliberado aprovar/ratificar por maioria.*)

(36) Deliberation: approved unanimously.

(PT: *Deliberação: aprovado por unanimidade.*)

- **D.2. Voter**

**Definition:** the institutional entity that exercises the right to vote in a given City Council deliberation.

**Markable:** corresponds to the complete noun phrase, including determiners/quantifiers and noun complements (in the form of prepositional phrases). In cases where the voter is **not** linguistically expressed in the text of the resolution (cf. (35), (36) and (38)), an **empty markable** should be inserted (SHIFT + mouse click in INCEpTION) immediately to the right of the corresponding vote markable (see Figure 2).

**Examples** (markable underlined):

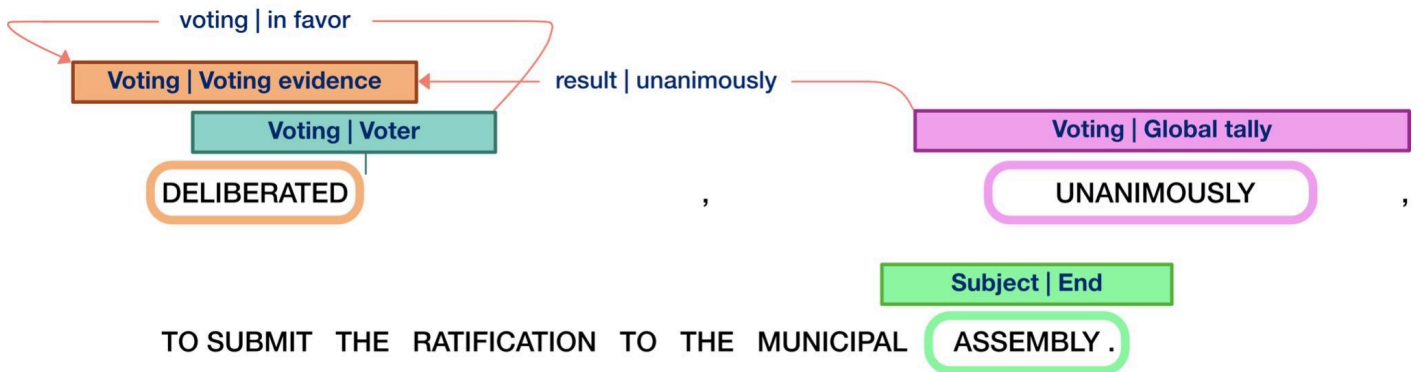
(37) The Municipal Executive deliberated by majority, with the votes in favor of those elected by PS and the abstention of the member elected by Nós, Cidadãos.

(PT: *O Executivo Municipal deliberou por maioria, com os votos a favor dos eleitos pelo PS e a abstenção da eleita pelo Nós, Cidadãos.*)

(38) Approved unanimously by those present at the public meeting of the Municipal Executive on 2022-05-02.

(PT: *Aprovada, por unanimidade, pelos presentes na reunião pública do Executivo Municipal de 2 de maio de 2022.*)

**Figure 2.** Illustrative example of voter annotation with an empty markable<sup>2</sup>.



- **D.3. Non-voter**

**Definition:** the individual institutional entity that does **not** exercise the right to vote in a given City Council deliberation.

**Markable:** corresponds to the full name of the individual institutional entity with voting rights, excluding professional or honorific titles such as “Ms. Councilor”, “Dr.”, “Eng.”, “Prof.”, etc.

**Annotation note:** include the text segment identifying the non-voting entity within the boundaries of the subject (cf. (39)). When this is not possible and the information occurs outside the subject boundaries (cf. (40)), a **positioning – non-present** link should be established between the non-voting entity markable and the corresponding deliberation markable.

**Examples** (markable underlined):

(39) [Before **[start]]** proceeding to the deliberation mentioned below, Councilor Paulo Ivo left the meeting room, as he is part of the Governing Bodies of the said Institution.

(PT: *Antes de se proceder à deliberação abaixo mencionada, o Senhor Vereador Paulo Ivo, ausentou-se da sala de reuniões, por fazer parte dos Órgãos Sociais da referida Instituição.*)

(40) At 11:45 a.m., Councilor Hugo Ribeiro left.  
[DELIBERATIONS **[agenda item]]**

<sup>2</sup> The English translation privileges literal correspondence with the Portuguese source text over idiomatic English syntax.

Portuguese source: “*Deliberado, por unanimidade, submeter a ratificação à Assembleia Municipal.*”

[CITY COUNCIL **[start]**] – Approval of the minute of the ordinary meeting of the City Council, held on 29 December 2022. Deliberated to approve [unanimously. **[end]**]

(PT: *Pelas 11:45 horas ausentou-se o Vereador Hugo Ribeiro.*

*DELIBERAÇÕES*

*CÂMARA – Aprovação da ata da reunião ordinária da Câmara Municipal, realizada em 29 de dezembro de 2022. Deliberado aprovar por unanimidade.)*

- **D.4. Global tally**

**Definition:** the unit representing the collective opinion of all or part of the set of voters.

**Markable:** corresponds to the full prepositional phrase expressing the form of approval of the resolution, which may occur:

- explicitly: through “*por unanimidade*” (unanimously) or “*por maioria*” (by majority) (cf. (41) and (42));
- implicitly: through other expressions indicating the totality or majority of voters (e.g., “*por todos os presentes*” (by all those present); cf. (43)), including cases of **secret ballots** in which the global tally (unanimously/by majority) is not explicitly stated in the text, but inferred from the voting results (e.g., “*7 votos a favor e 6 votos em branco*” (7 votes in favour and 6 blank votes); cf. (44)).

**Examples** (markable underlined):

(41) The Council unanimously deliberated to authorise the correction of the certificate.

(PT: *A Câmara deliberou, por unanimidade, autorizar a correção da certidão.*)

(42) The Municipal Executive deliberated by majority to ratify the protocol.

(PT: *O Executivo Municipal deliberou por maioria a ratificação do protocolo.*)

(43) The Council deliberated, by all those present, to give a favourable opinion on the legal transaction.

(PT: *A Câmara deliberou, por todos os presentes, dar parecer favorável ao negócio jurídico.*)

(44) In a secret ballot, it was approved with seven votes in favour and six blank votes.

(PT: *Em votação por escrutínio secreto, aprovada, com 7 votos a favor e 6 votos em branco.*)

## II. Link structures

- **object of vote\_link** (connects voting evidence to subject)

**Definition:** relation identifying the content or subject of the vote. Links the voting evidence markable to the corresponding subject, indicating what is being decided/deliberated.

**Annotation note:** when more than one deliberation occurs within the same subject, the link should be established individually between each voting evidence markable and its corresponding subject; the (implicit) voter will be inferred from the established links.

**Directionality:** from the voting evidence to the subject.

- **voting\_link** (connects voter to voting evidence)

**Definition:** relation representing the position of a voter regarding a specific vote. Links the voter to the voting evidence markable with one of the following values:

- in favour
- against
- abstention
- not present

**Directionality:** from the voter to the voting evidence.

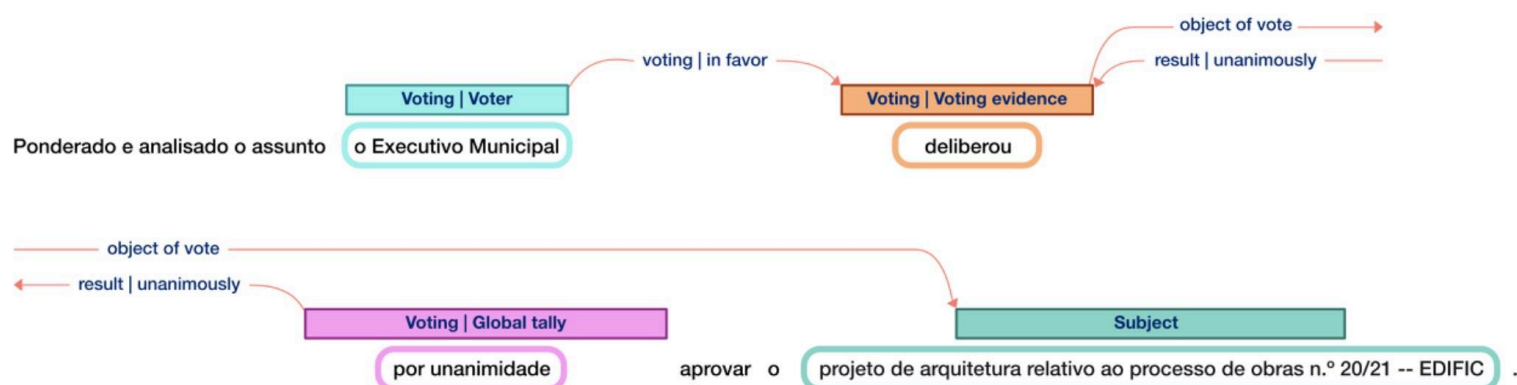
- **result\_link** (connects global tally to voting evidence)

**Definition:** relation indicating the global outcome of the vote, as expressed by the form of approval (“unanimously” or “by majority”). Links the global tally to the voting evidence markable with one of the following values:

- unanimously
- by majority

**Directionality:** from the global tally to the voting evidence.

**Figure 3.** Illustrative example of annotation in the Voting layer<sup>3</sup>.



<sup>3</sup> English translation: “Considered and analyzed the subject, the Municipal Executive unanimously deliberated to approve the architectural project relating to construction process no. 20/21 - EDIFIC.” The English translation privileges literal correspondence with the Portuguese source text over idiomatic English syntax.